28 February 1968

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FEATHERS AND DOWN, WATERFOWL; RECLAIMED AND TAN-O-QUIL-QM TREATED

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the chemical modification (see 6.3) of feathers and down reclaimed from used sleeping bags. The sleeping bags shall be furnished by the Government.

1.2 Classification.- The waterfowl feathers and down shall be of the following types:

Type:

I - Feathers
II - Down

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

V-T-276	- Thread, Cotton
QQ-S-781	- Steel Strapping, Flat
CCC-C-429	- Cloth, Osnaburg, Cotton
CCC-C-432	- Cloth, Sheeting, Cotton, (Unbleached, Bleached and Dyed)
CCC-T-191	- Textile Test Methods
PPP-F-320	- Fiberboard, Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock (Container Grade) and Cut Shapes
PPP-S-760	- Strapping, Nonmetallic, (and Connectors)

FSC 8320

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MILITARY

MIL-C-332 - Cloth, Balloon, Cotton

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

Fed. Std. No. 148 - Classification, Identification, and Testing of Feather Filling Material
Fed. Std. No. 751 - Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of specifications, standards, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procurement activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Laboratory report approval.- Unless otherwise specified at the time of submission of bid (see 6.2), the bidder shall submit to the contracting officer a certified copy of a recent laboratory report which demonstrate his capability to produce a finished product which has been tested in accordance with methods specified in 4.5, and found to comply with the requirements of this specification. Any of the following types of reports will be satisfactory from the standpoint of this requirement:

(a) An independent or commercial laboratory report.
(b) The prospective supplier's own laboratory report.
(c) A Governmental laboratory report from a contract within not more than six months of submission of bid.

The purpose of the above requirement is to assist the Government to determine the capability of the bidder to supply a product meeting all the requirements of this specification. The submission of an acceptable report under this requirement shall not be construed as relieving the supplier from subsequently meeting all requirements of this specification.

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3.2 Preproduction sample approval.- Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, a one-pound sample of the finished product shall be submitted or made ready for the contracting officer or his authorized representative for inspection as specified in 4.2. The approval of the preproduction sample authorizes the commencement of production but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with all the requirements of this specification.

3.3 Materials.- The used sleeping bags shall be furnished by the Government (see 3.6).

3.4 Processing.- The feather and down filling material shall be completely removed from the sleeping bags (see 3.6). The Government filling materials shall be processed, sampled and packed in such a manner that the separate identity of each lot is preserved throughout.

3.4.1 Dusting.- The feather and down mixture shall be dusted by a method approved by the Government to remove loose dirt and dust.

3.4.2 Fractionation (see 3.6).- The dusted mixture shall be fractionated to separate the down from the feathers by a method approved by the Government. Unless otherwise specified or approved by the contracting officer, the content of "usable" feather stock in the waste fraction shall not exceed 12.0 percent by weight. For this purpose, "usable" feather stock shall be defined as specified in 4.4.1. Subsequent to fractionation, feathers and down shall be processed separately.

3.4.3 Washing.- The materials shall be washed with a detergent in water at approximately 100°F. and rinsed until the rinse water is completely clean. The washed material shall have a turbidity value of not less than 75 centimeters when tested as specified in 4.4.2 and 4.4.2.1.

3.4.3.1 Drying.- If the materials are to be subjected immediately to the chemical modification, they need not be dried. If the materials are dried prior to treatment, they shall not be dried to bone dry condition.

3.4.4 Treatment.- The washed product shall be given an approved TAN-O-QUIL-QM treatment (see 3.6 and 6.3). The use of treatment materials other than those approved is prohibited.

3.5 Finished product.- The finished product shall conform to the applicable requirements in table I, when tested as specified in 4.5.

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TABLE I.- Finished requirements

	Type I	Type II
Oxygen number, max.	6.0	6.0
Filling power in cms., after 2 launderings	3/	3/
Chrome content, % min, 1/	0.35	0.25
Acidity (pH)	3.0-4.5	3.0-4.
Odor 2/	None	None
Composition	As in 3.5.1.1	As in 3.5.1.2
Usable feather stock in waste fraction, % max.	As in 3.4.2	-

1/ Expressed as chromic oxide.

2/ No odor of putrefaction.

3/ There is no requirement for filling power, however the filling power after 2 launderings shall be determined and reported (as in 4.5) for future use.

3.5.1 Composition.-

3.5.1.1 Type I.- The treated feathers shall conform to the following composition requirements when tested as specified in 4.5. Classification of components shall be in accordance with the applicable definitions in Fed. Std. No. 148.

(a) Feathers including whole and damaged waterfowl feathers, non waterfowl feathers, feather fiber and down fiber.	88% min.
(b) Pure down (and plumules)	10% max.
(c) Residual matter	2% max.

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3.5.1.2 Type II.- The treated down shall conform to the following composition requirements when tested as specified in 4.5. Classification of components shall be in accordance with the applicable definitions in Fed. Std. No. 148:

(a) Pure down (and plumules), down fiber and feather fiber	80% min.
(b) Small waterfowl feathers including quill feathers, damaged-feathers, and non-waterfowl feathers.	18% max.
(c) Residual matter	2% max.

3.6 Contractor information.- The supplier shall record and furnish the following information for each lot (see 3.3, 3.4, 3.4.2 and 3.5):

a. Number of sleeping bags processed.
b. Weight of filling material obtained.
c. Weight of down, feathers, and waste obtained after fractionating.
d. Weight of TAN-O-QUIL-QM treated feathers and down.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance.- Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection.- The preproduction sample submitted in accordance with 3.2 shall be examined and tested to determine compliance with the requirements of section 3.

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4.3 Component and material inspection.- In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4 In-process inspection.- Inspection shall be conducted to see that the processing is in accordance with the specified requirements. The Government reserves the right to excluded from consideration for acceptance any material or service for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance. The supplier shall certify conformance to the following requirements:

(a) Use of approved chemical compounds, in required ratios (see 3.4.4).
(b) Other processing details required in this specification.

4.4.1 Usable stock in waste (type I).- The waste shall be examined for content of "usable" feather stock (see 3.4.2). The waste accumulated from each lot shall be considered a lot for this examination. A composite minimum 24-ounce sample shall be made up of samplings of not less than 4 ounces each from various portions of the lot, and thoroughly mixed. From this sample, a specimen of not less than 8 grams shall be taken and weighed to the nearest 0.01 gram. The usable stock consisting primarily of feathers (excluding quill feathers) and down (and plumules) shall be separated from the specimen. For the purposes of this determination, "usable" stock components are characterized by a slower rate of fall, compared to obvious quill feathers, when dropped from a height of 18 inches or more. Tangles and clusters which are not easily separated for individual component classification, shall be classified as "usable" stock, according to the rate of fall. (These distinctions are in recognition of the nature and capabilities of the fractionation process). The "usable" stock components shall be weighed to the nearest 0.01 gram, and the content calculated and reported to the nearest 0.01 percent based on the original specimen weight. Except as otherwise specified or accepted by the contracting officer, waste which contains more than 12.0 percent of "usable" stock shall be refractionated to recover the excess.

4.4.2 Turbidity of cleaned feathers and down.- The cleaned feathers and down (before chemical modification treatment) shall be tested for turbidity value in accordance with method 10 of Fed. Std. No. 148. The sample shall be a 20-ounce (minimum) composite sample made up of samplings from the several washer loads in each 1,000 pounds of product or fraction thereof which shall be considered a lot for purposes of the turbidity test. The composite sample shall be dried, conditioned, and mixed with a rod to insure an adequate composite, before taking the specimen for test.

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4.4.2.1 Approval for treatment.- It is not required under quality assurance procedures that the turbidity test be completed prior to commencement of the chemical modification treatment. However, failure of the lot to meet the 75 centimeter turbidity value requirements shall be cause for rejection of the finished product corresponding to the in-process testing lot regardless of conformance to specified finished requirements.

4.5 Testing of the end item.- Testing of the finished product shall be performed in accordance with the methods specified in table II. The physical and chemical values specified in section 3 apply to the results of the determinations made on a sample unit for test purposes as specified in the applicable test methods. All test reports shall contain the individual values utilized in expressing the final result. The test methods indicated by number shall be performed as specified in Fed. Std. No. 148. The sample unit for testing shall be a thoroughly mixed 24 ounce composite of the finished product. Not more than 6 ounces shall be taken from any level A (see 5.1.1) package (bag). For larger bags, samplings shall be from top center, bottom, and opposite sides of the bag, with not more than 12 ounces from any one bag. Care shall be taken in mixing to prevent damaging or compressing the material. The lot size shall be expressed in terms of pounds. The sample size (number of the sample units) and the acceptance number shall be in accordance with the following:

Lot size (pounds)	Sample size (units)	Maximum acceptable number of test failures
3,200 or less	2	0
3,201 up to and including 10,000	3	0
10,001 up to and including 35,000	5	0
35,001 and over	8	1

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TABLE II.- Test methods 1/

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test Method
Usable feather stock in waste fraction	3.4.2	4.4.1
Oxygen number	3.5	4
Filling power, after 2 launderings	3.5	1 and 4.5.1, 2/, 3/
Chrome content	3.5	9
Acidity (pH)	3.5	8
Odor	3.5	11
Composition	3.5.1.1 and 3.5.1.2	2

1/ Testing may be performed under prevailing conditions except in settlement of dispute in which case standard conditions as defined in Fed. Std. No. 148 shall apply.

2/ Paragraph 4.5.1 of this specification.

3/ The supplier shall identify the filling power after laundering of each lot of feathers and down which he processes (see 3.5). This identification of the filling power shall be recorded on each bale and bag (see 5.3) and also reported to the contracting officer by bale number.

4.5.1 Laundering procedure.- Place approximately 1 ounce of the composite sample in a 17 by 6-inch cloth bag made of water repellent and preshrunk cloth conforming to type I, class 2 of MIL-C-332. The bag shall be tightly seamed and closed to prevent loss of material during laundering. The filled bag shall then be subjected to two successive complete launderings (wool method) in accordance with the general procedure of method 5556 of CCC-T-191. The dryer shall be adjusted to have a stack temperature of 150°F. to 170°F. After the two wash cycles, the material shall be removed from the bag, conditioned, and tested for filling power in accordance with method 1 of Fed. Std. No. 148.

4.6 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements.-

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4.6.1 Inspection of fabricated bags and bale-boards.- Fabricated bags and bale-boards shall be inspected to determine conformance with the applicable requirements of 5.1 and 5.2. The acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 defects per 100 units and the inspection level shall be S-2 of MIL-STD-105.

4.6.2 Examination of the end item.- The end item (completely packaged and packed product) shall be inspected in accordance with the examinations and tests specified in 4.6.2.1, and 4.6.2.2 and 4.6.2.3.

4.6.2.1 Weight.- The lot shall be unacceptable if the content of the bags in the sample is less than the total content weights indicated on the bags. The number of bags to be selected for the weight examination shall be in accordance with level S-4 of MIL-STD-105.

4.6.2.1.1 Standard weight basis.- When specified, or in case of dispute, the weight basis for acceptance shall be determined by correction of unconditioned weight, to weight at equilibrium under standard atmospheric conditions as defined in Fed. Std. No. 148. At the time of weighing, a random sample of product not less than 1/4 pound shall be taken from the contents of the bag, and placed immediately in a tared closable container. The sample shall then be weighed in the closed container. The sample shall then be spread in a shallow layer in a tray and stored in the standard atmosphere for not less than 24 hours, with occasional stirring. The conditioned sample shall then be weighed, and the gain or loss calculated to a percentage based on the original sample weight. The percentage correction shall then be applied to the unconditioned weight of the contents of the bag to determine its weight on the standard weight basis.

4.6.2.2 Packaging examination.- The sample unit shall be one bag of product. The inspection level shall be S-1 of MIL-STD-105 and the AQL shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below:

Defects

Not packaged in accordance with specified packaging level.
Bag not new, or any patch.
Not closed as specified.
Wire tie broken or not tightly turned to accomplish a secure closure.
Any hole, rip, tear, open seam, any weak places in bag which may develop into a hole; backtacking and backstitching not as specified.
Bag wet.

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4.6.2.3 Packing examination.- The sample unit shall be one bale or shipping container. The inspection level shall be level I of MIL-STD-105 and the acceptable quality level shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below:

Defects

Not packed in accordance with specified packing level.
Bags not compressed to specified size.
Does not contain the specified number of bags.
Kraft facing of baling board not on outside.
Any board missing or strap missing.
Baling board or strap too loose or not placed to assure safe delivery of contents.
Marking - omitted, incomplete, illegible, incorrect, not as specified or not in proper location.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.- Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.- Thirty-five ± 5 pounds of type I product whereas twenty-five ± 3 pounds of type I product shall be packaged in a new (not used or laundered) plain textile bag fabricated from cotton sheeting conforming to type VIII of CCC-C-432, or osnaburg conforming to class 2 of CCC-C-429. Fabrics of equivalent weight and construction will be acceptable.

5.1.1.1 Bag, construction.- The bags shall have a finished length and width measured flat, of approximately 72 by 36 inches and shall be constructed in accordance with the following requirements: The side and bottom shall be seamed with 5 to 6 stitches per inch in seam type SSa-2, with either stitching type 401 or 301, conforming to Fed. Std. No. 751. The stitching shall be at least 5/8 inch from the cut edge of the fabric or 1/4 inch from a selvage edge and the rows shall be at least 1/8 inch apart. The ends of all stitching, when not caught in other seams or stitching, shall be backstitched or backtacked at least 1 inch. The thread used for seaming shall be cotton, machine type IA1, or IB1, unbleached, ticket No. 12, 4 ply conforming to V-T-276.

5.1.1.1.1 Type 301 stitching.- Thread breaks in stitching shall be backstitched not less than 1 inch at each break. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching. Threads ends shall be trimmed.

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5.1.1.1.2 Type 401 stitching.- Thread breaks in stitching shall be over-stitched not less than 1-1/2 inches at each break. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching. Thread ends shall be trimmed.

5.1.1.2 Closure.- The closure of the top of the bag after filling shall be effected by means of two double loops of 0.072 inch thick galvanized soft iron or steel wire ties of not less than 6 inches long, having a 1/2 inch diameter eye formed at each end. One tie shall be applied at the base of an ear formed by gathering the cloth evenly and the second tie applied at a distance approximately 1 inch from the first tie with the twisted ends of two ties alternated and facing in opposite direction.

5.1.2 Level C.- Feathers and down shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage and deterioration during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice where it meets these requirements..

5.2 Packing.- Packing shall be levels A or C as specified (see 6.2)

5.2.1 Level A.- Three bags of type I product whereas four bags of type II product (see 5.1.1) shall be placed between two baling boards and compressed by machine so as to form a bale approximately one-fifth of the original volume. Bales thus formed shall measure approximately 60 by 24 by 20 inches.

5.2.1.1 Baling boards.- Baling boards shall be not less than 0.075 inch thick solid fiberboard conforming to type SF, class domestic, grade 200 of PPP-F-320, except that at least one face of the board shall be not less then 0.010 inch kraft paperboard. Two such baling boards, size 58 by 36 inches, each with a score line placed 6 inches from each 58-inch edge in such manner that the kraft facing is on the outside when in a folded position, shall be used in each bale, one board on top of bags being baled, and one on the bottom. The boards shall be bent at the score lines thereby forming a fiberboard cap 58 inches in length, 24 inches in width, with 6-inch flanges extended down over the side of the bale.

5.2.1.2 Strapping.- Not less than eight straps shall be used on each bale; straps shall be affixed girthwise around the sides, top and bottom of the bale over the baling boards. The two outside straps shall be placed 4 inches in from each end and the intermediate straps placed equidistant between the end bands. All strapping shall be flat not less than 3/8 inch wide by 0.020 inches thick conforming to type I, class A of QQ-S-781 or type II of PPP-S-760.

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5.2.2 Level C.- Feathers and down packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rates for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with the rules or regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.- In addition to any special marking (see footnote "3/" in table II of para 4.5) required by the contract or order, shipments shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.- The treated feathers and down covered by this specification are intended primarily as filling material for sleeping bags, pillows and other items.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) When laboratory report approval is not required (see 3.1).
(c) When preproduction sample is not required (see 3.2).
(d) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 *Approved TAN-O-QUIL-QM type treatment.*- The TAN-O-QUIL-QM type treatment consists of the co-application of chrome tanning and water-repellent compounds under controlled conditions to enhance the effective bulk of the feathers and to improve their hygienic properties. Approval of such compounds and their applications for use under this specification is the responsibility of the U.S. Army Natick Laboratories, Natick, Massachusetts and is based on extensive tests, including those for toxicity, which are not set forth in this specification. Because of the time necessary to conduct full evaluation, only those chemicals already approved for the standard TAN-O-QUIL-QM treatment and so listed in the invitation for bid or request for proposal, shall be considered acceptable for the related procurement.

6.3.1 Materials.- The standard approved TAN-O-QUIL-QM treatment makes use of a basic chrome sulfate as the "tanning" agent. The repellent is a myristylato chromium complex normally supplied as 30 percent solids in isopropyl alcohol. Common salt and sulfuric acid are also required.

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6.3.1.1 Preparation of materials.- The approved chrome "tanning" agent is pre-dissolved in boiling water, at approximately 10 pounds per 25 gallons. The approved water-repellent is pre-dissolved in boiling water, at approximately 3 pounds per 25 gallons, by adding under the surface of the water through a tube and continuing boiling for at least 5 minutes after the addition has been completed.

Precaution - Isopropyl alcohol will be volatilized during this preparation. The working area should be adequately ventilated, and the presence of open flames or sparks (e.g., open-type electric motors) should be avoided.

The repellent should be used within 1/2 hour of preparation.

6.3.2 Procedure.- Immerse the washed feathers or down in water at 100°F. using a ratio of three to four gallons of water to one pound of waterfowl feathers or down. The weight of the feathers and down shall be calculated on a dry basis. Add 20 pounds of salt for every 100 pounds of feathers or down and sufficient sulfuric acid to bring the bath to a pH of 3.4 to 3.6. Add 10 pounds of "tanning" agent (approved) and 3 pounds of commercial repellent (approved) per 100 pounds of feathers or 10 pounds of "tanning" agent (approved) and 3/4 pound of commercial repellent (approved) per 100 pounds of down. Hold with intermittent agitation until the turbidity of the bath has cleared up. This usually occurs within one hour and is considered to have been reached when newsprint can be read through a clear glass container about 3 inches high, containing a sample of the bath placed directly on the print to be read. Rinse feathers or down, drain extract and dry. Feathers and down should be removed from the drier as soon as they are dry. Care should be exercised so as not to over-dry them.

6.3.3 Special notes.-

(a) Thorough cleaning of the feathers and down prior to treatment is essential to achieving full benefit from the treatment. The intermediate turbidity test requirement (see 3.4.3) is a means of assurance that the effect of the treatment will not be materially lowered by presence of extraneous material.

(b) Conformance to the materials of procedures described above does not relieve suppliers from conformance to other requirements of this specification. Characteristics of processing equipment and conditions, as well as the characteristics of the unprocessed feathers and down, must be considered in controlling the processing to assure satisfactory results.

Custodian:

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Preparing activity:

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-F-43572 (GL)	Feathers and Down, Waterfowl; Reclaimed and Tan-O-Quil-QM Treated

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION

b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*

4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*

- ☐ VENDOR
- ☐ USER
- ☐ MANUFACTURER
- ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	7b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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